

FULL OPERATING PICTURE · AUGUST 2026

Sổ Sạch

The AI bookkeeper on Zalo for Vietnam's 5.2 million household businesses.

Everything the first briefing withheld: unit economics, the channel, the moat, the risks and the numbers we don't like.

Prepared for a partnership conversation, not a fundraising one.

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01 – THE SHOCK

The customer acquisition was done by the state.

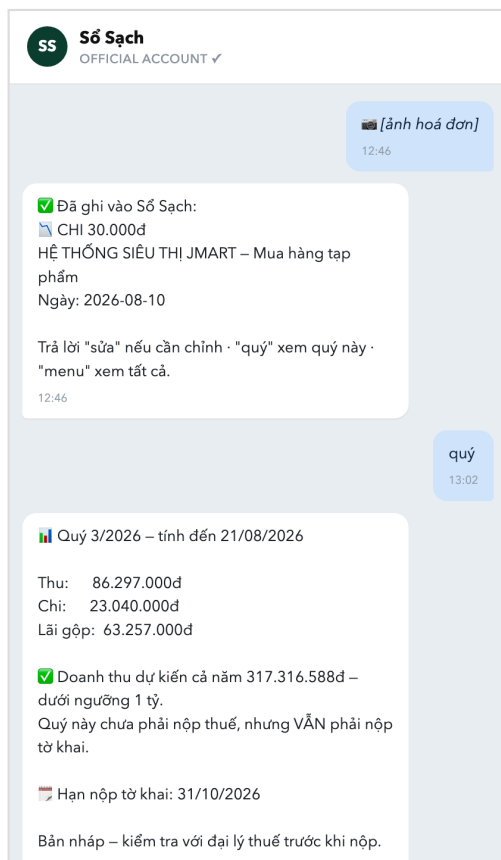
Instrument	Effect	Who it hits
Abolition of thuế khoán, 01/01/2026	lump-sum assessment replaced by self-declaration on real books	5.2M hộ kinh doanh
Decree 70/2025, now Decree 254/2026	e-invoicing from a connected cash register above 1 tỷ VND annual revenue (in force 01/07/2026)	the upper tier – and the ones who cross it unknowingly
Decree 141/2026	taxable threshold raised from 500 triệu to 1 tỷ VND	most of the market is exempt – but must still file
Circular 40/2021	presumptive rates on revenue: 1%+0.5% / 3%+1.5% / 5%+2% by activity	everyone above the threshold

The obligation is not optional and not one-off. It recurs every quarter, with a filing deadline on the last day of the month following. A product tied to a statutory deadline has a re-activation engine competitors have to buy with marketing.

Most of them owe nothing and must file anyway. That is the wedge: we are not selling tax savings, we are selling the disappearance of an administrative fear.

02 – THE PRODUCT LOOP

Photograph. Confirm. Filed.



THE BOT'S ACTUAL PRODUCTION REPLIES

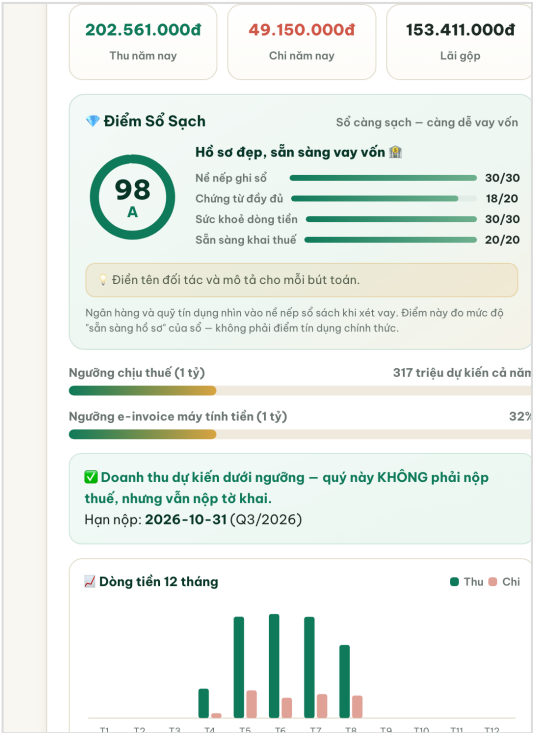
Zalo is the whole interface. 77M Vietnamese use it daily; there is no app to install, no password to remember, no desktop.

Vision does the typing. Claude reads the receipt – amount, supplier, date – and the household confirms rather than transcribes.

Revenue is not photographed. A café does not print a receipt for 200 coffees, so daily takings arrive as one typed line: *thu 2tr4*. Photos carry the costs, one line carries the sales.

The declaration is a by-product. Form 01/CNKD is drafted continuously; at quarter end there is nothing to prepare, only something to check.

From photographs to a filed declaration.



THE LIVE WEB BOOK – SCORE 98/A

Tờ khai thuế quý – BẢN NHẬP

01/CNKD (Thông tư 40/2021/TT-BTC) – BẢN NHẬP / DRAFT
Quý 3 năm 2026

Ngày lập	2026-08-21
Người nộp thuế	Bún Bò Cô Hai
Ngành nghề	Dịch vụ có gắn với hàng hoá, ăn uống, sản xuất, vận tải
Doanh thu tính thuế trong quý	86.297.000đ
Thuế GTGT (3%)	0đ
Thuế TNCN (1.5%)	0đ
TỔNG THUẾ PHẢI NỘP	0đ
Hạn nộp tờ khai	2026-10-31

Doanh thu dự kiến cả năm dưới ngưỡng chịu thuế – vẫn phải nộp tờ khai.

Bản nhập do Sổ Sạch soạn. Kiểm tra với đại lý thuế trước khi nộp. / Draft prepared by Sổ Sạch – verify with a licensed tax agent before filing.

Tạo bởi Sổ Sạch – sosach.com.vn

FORM 01/CNKD, DRAFTED CONTINUOUSLY FROM THE BOOK

Sample book of a noodle shop, generated by the real engines – not a design comp. The score is deliberately hard: an early version graded every household A, which is worthless to a lender. Below the threshold the declaration shows 0đ due – and says the filing is still owed, which is exactly the misunderstanding that gets households fined.

04 – WHY THIS IS A CORRECTNESS PRODUCT

The first real receipt found four ways to be confidently wrong.

We are showing you our bug list. Most decks don't. This is the discipline the category demands.

Failure	What it would have done to a household	State
Date read as MM/DD	a receipt printed 10/08 booked as 8 October – entries in the wrong quarter, wrong declaration	Fixed
"30.000" parsed as 30	the dot separates thousands in Vietnam – every formatted amount booked 1,000× too small, silently	Fixed
Silent fallback to demo data	any model failure returned an invented supplier and a plausible amount, indistinguishable from a real read	Fixed
Server clock vs Vietnam clock	an entry dated 1 April fell into Q1, 1 January into the previous year – the wrong quarterly filing	Fixed
Empty book at mid-year signup	a business turning over 1.44 tỷ VND was told it was exempt, because seven blank months read as no trading	Fixed

None of these ever reached a household.

All five were found by tests written before the pilot – 72 of them, run across four timezones on every change.

05 – MARKET

Two customer shapes, one engine.

	Size	Definition & source
TAM	5.2M	household businesses required to keep books from 2026 (GSO)
SAM	~1.8M	smartphone-active, revenue 200 triệu – 3 tỷ VND – duty is real, capability is not
SOM (Y3)	40,000	~2.2% of SAM, district by district from HCMC outward

SEGMENT A – ONLINE SELLERS

Shopee, TikTok Shop, Lazada. Tax is withheld at source by the platform, so their problem is reconciliation and reclaiming what was over-withheld. Digitally fluent, reachable online, lower support cost, faster to convert.

SEGMENT B – STREET RETAIL

Eateries, kiosks, market stalls, repair shops. Cash, no cash register, no accountant, often no email. They need the book itself and a warning in human language before the threshold bites. Unreachable by advertising – reachable through their tax agent.

06 – BUSINESS MODEL

Priced for a street vendor. Sold by the person they already trust.

Line	Price	Y3 share	What it buys
Core	69k VND/mo (~\$2.70)	62%	photo ledger, thresholds, declaration draft, Zalo bot
Pro	149k VND/mo (~\$5.90)	23%	multi-location, exports, e-invoice via partner API, priority support
Tax-agent channel	30% rev-share	15%	dashboard for an agent running 20-200 households – the trust channel becomes the sales channel

\$0.20-0.40

COGS / USER / MONTH

>85%

GROSS MARGIN AT SCALE

<\$4

BLENDED CAC

~\$3.30

BLENDED ARPU / MONTH

~2.5 mo

CAC PAYBACK

COGS is dominated by vision inference, roughly 20-40 US cents per active user per month at current volumes and model pricing, and it falls as we route routine receipts to smaller models. Infrastructure and Zalo fees are effectively fixed.

Quarterly deadlines are a churn counterweight. A lapsed user has a legal reason to come back four times a year, and we hold the book they need.

07 – THE MOAT NOBODY CAN SHORTCUT

A verified Zalo Official Account is a licence, not a signup.

Gate	What it actually required
Personal identity	the founder's own Zalo account had to pass biometric eKYC before an OA could even be created – the wall that stops most foreign-run attempts
Corporate verification	four review rounds; rejections for a composited signature, for naming Zalo in the description, and for business evidence that could not be matched to the company register
Domain ownership	cleared only once the company held sosach.com.vn in its own name – a .com.vn requires a Vietnamese registrant and, for a foreign-represented company, a workaround we had to find
Data residency	Zalo restricts user data to Vietnamese-IP endpoints since 2024; we established by live test which fields actually survive a foreign endpoint – a fact competitors will have to buy with their own months
Paid tier	a verified OA still cannot send a message until an annual OA package is purchased through a pre-funded Zalo Business account – a rail with its own onboarding

Eleven months. Four rejections. One Vietnamese company, one wet seal.

A competitor with more money does not get to skip any of it.

08 – DISTRIBUTION

We don't chase households. We recruit whoever already has them.

Channel	Mechanic	CAC	Honest limitation
Đại lý thuế	licensed tax agents each serve 20-200 households; they get a dashboard, we give 30% of revenue	<\$2	slow to recruit; each agent is a relationship, not a signup
QR flyers, market streets	physical presence where segment B actually is; scan opens the Zalo OA directly	~\$3	labour-intensive, does not scale beyond a city without staff
Artefact virality	every declaration and receipt shared on Zalo carries the mark – the customer's paperwork recruits	~\$0	unproven at scale; we model it at zero

THE NUMBER WE DON'T LIKE

At 30% rev-share on a 69k VND subscription, a tax agent running 12 households earns about 248,000 VND a month – roughly ten US dollars. That is not yet a reason for a professional to change how they work. The channel only becomes rational for the agent at around 100 households (~2.07M VND/month), which is why the pilot is sized at 100 and why agent recruitment, not household acquisition, is the metric that actually decides this business.

09 – THE ASSET UNDERNEATH

We record how much to trust every figure.

This is the difference between a subscription list and something a lender can underwrite.

Provenance tag	Meaning	Underwriting weight
photo	read from an image of a document the business actually received	High
manual	typed by the business – daily takings, cash sales	Medium
declared	carried in from an old notebook or another app at signup	None
bank / pos / einvoice	third-party confirmed – the roadmap target	Highest

Điểm Số Sạch – a 0–100 credit-readiness score built from recording density against expected trading days, documentary completeness, margin and month-to-month steadiness, and filing readiness. It grades A to D and it is deliberately hard: an early version gave every household an A, which is worthless to a lender.

Declared history earns nothing. A household can arrive with three years of notebook, obtain a correct tax position immediately, and still start at a low score. History fixes your filing; only evidence builds your credit file.

The strategic thesis. At 40,000 households the portfolio is a structured, provenance-weighted record of how Vietnamese micro-business actually trades – the input a bank or credit fund currently cannot buy at any price, because nobody is collecting it this way.

10 – COMPETITION

MISA gives the software away. We still win the vendor.

	Vendor language	Zalo-native	Explains & files	Agent channel	Provenance
MISA / KiotViet / Sapo	No	Partial	No	No	No
Tax agents, manual	Yes	Partial	Yes	–	No
Spreadsheet / notebook	Yes	No	No	No	No
Sổ Sạch	Yes	Yes	Yes	Built-in	Yes

Free is not the threat people assume. MISA's free tier is free desktop accounting software for a person who does not know what a ledger is and does not own a laptop. The price was never the obstacle; the form factor was.

The realistic threat is a Vietnamese incumbent copying the Zalo form factor. Our answer is the agent network and the provenance data, neither of which is in the code – and a head start measured in regulatory approvals rather than features.

11 – WHAT THE SEGMENT SUPPORTS

The standalone arithmetic, on the table.

Illustrative economics of the standalone path – what the segment supports, not a plan being funded.

	Y1 (2027)	Y2 (2028)	Y3 (2029)
Paying subscribers	2,000	12,000	40,000
Active tax agents	25	120	400
ARR	\$70k	\$450k	\$1.6M
EBITDA	–\$90k	+\$60k	+\$520k
Gross margin	85%	87%	88%
Monthly churn	3.5%	2.6%	2.0%

Every assumption, on the table: blended ARPU ~\$3.30/month · CAC under \$4 · churn 3.5% falling to 2% · 30% of revenue paid away on the agent channel · COGS \$0.20–0.40 per active user.

We deliberately reject this market's hockey stick. The pitch we were shown – 200,000 monthly actives in eighteen months at \$7 ARPU against a free incumbent – is not a plan, it is a wish. We would rather be held to 40,000 at \$3.30 and hit it. With a partner's distribution the curve changes shape; that is precisely the conversation.

12 – RISKS & KILL CRITERIA

What would make this fail, and what we've agreed to do about it.

Risk	Why it is real	Our response
Agents won't sell	30% of \$2.70 is small money for a professional until volume arrives	Kill criterion: if agents decline at 30% rev-share, we pivot to agent-only tooling sold as a seat licence
Households won't pay	69k VND/month is real money to a street vendor, and the obligation is new	Kill criterion: pilot week-4 retention below 25% means the wedge is wrong and we stop
Platform dependency	Zalo can change API terms, pricing or data policy unilaterally	the web product works standalone; Zalo is the acquisition channel, not the only runtime
Regulatory reversal	thresholds have already moved once (500 triệu to 1 tỷ) and could move again	thresholds and rates are configuration, not code; the filing duty survives any threshold change
Tax correctness	we compute figures a household will file; being wrong is an existential risk, not a bug	everything is marked BẢN NHẬP / DRAFT and deferred to a licensed agent; rates validated before the pilot
Key person	one founder, in Vietnam, holding the identity that unlocks the Zalo channel	a Vietnamese ground lead and a second admin on every account – both natural early moves of a partnership

The distribution risk is already retired.

Aug 2026
OA VERIFIED & SENDING

US-hosted
RECEIPT PIPELINE PROVEN

.com.vn
DOMAIN HELD BY THE COMPANY

01/CNKD
AUTO-DRAFTED FROM THE BOOK

When	Milestone	Proof we will show you
Now	Product live end-to-end: Zalo bot, ledger, score, declaration, agent dashboard, billing rails	sosach.com.vn
Q4 2026	100-household PAID pilot, two HCMC districts, via 3–5 licensed tax agents	week-4 retention ≥25%
Q1 2027	Zalo Mini App (zero install) + Q4 filing campaign; first agent cohort at 50+ households each	500 paying
Mid-2027	2,000 subscribers · 25 active agents · e-invoice partner API live	\$70k ARR run-rate
2028-29	southern provinces via the agent network; first credit-data conversations with lenders	\$1.6M ARR · EBITDA +\$520k

14 – TEAM

One founder, in the country, with the identity that opens the channel.

Yuri Frassi – founder. Italian, resident in Hồ Chí Minh City, owner and legal representative of CÔNG TY TNHH OFFICINE GẮP, a Vietnamese company with a licence covering software sales. Background in cultural production and delivery across Italy, Saudi Arabia and Vietnam – a discipline of shipping physical projects to fixed deadlines in unfamiliar regulatory systems.

What that background actually buys here: the eleven-month Zalo verification was not an engineering problem, it was a bureaucratic one – company filings, wet seals, a domain registry that assumes a national ID. That is the work this founder has done for a decade in three countries.

Execution evidence. The product you can open today – ledger, tax engine, scoring, agent dashboard, Zalo integration, billing – was built and put into production solo, with AI leverage, alongside the regulatory work. Whatever you conclude about the market, the shipping speed is not in question.

THE GAP, NAMED

There is no Vietnamese co-founder and no ground team yet. For a product sold in Vietnamese to Vietnamese micro-businesses through Vietnamese professionals, that is the single largest structural weakness in this company – and the first thing a partnership closes, with a country lead inside the partner's own organisation.

15 – THE SHAPE OF A PARTNERSHIP

What each side puts on the table.

WHAT WE BRING

A working instrument against a statutory deadline. A verified Zalo channel that took eleven months of bureaucracy nobody can compress. The correctness discipline, the provenance model, the scoring engine – and a founder in the country who has already made the early mistakes at his own expense.

WHAT A PARTNER BRINGS

Distribution at a scale we cannot buy: an existing base, a field force, branches and licences, a Vietnamese ground team, and the balance sheet to treat a five-million-business segment as a programme rather than a pilot. People these households already deal with.

THE FIRST NINETY DAYS

Every rate validated by a licensed tax agent before any household relies on a figure the engine produced.

A 100-household paid pilot through the partner's existing channel – their base, their branches, not our flyers.

A Vietnamese country lead inside the partner's organisation, running the ground work from day one.

Day 90 is a decision point with real retention data on the table – continue, restructure, or stop.

16 – WHERE THIS LEAVES US

We are not raising money.

You now have the full operating picture. What we want next is a working conversation, not a term sheet.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING FOR

An operating conversation: your reading of the pilot design, of the agent channel, and of what your organisation could carry in the first ninety days.

WHAT COMES NEXT

Structure is discussed only after the pilot design is agreed. First the ninety days and the retention data – then, and only then, the form the partnership should take.

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